

The *Sourdough* Cheat Sheet.

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• Hydration → water (per 500 g flour)

HYDRATION	WATER	BEST FOR
65%	325 g	Sandwich, beginner
70%	350 g	Easy country
75%	375 g	Classic country
78%	390 g	Open crumb
80%	400 g	Focaccia
85%	425 g	Ciabatta
100%	500 g	Pan de cristal

+ 5–8% for whole grain blends.

• Bulk fermentation @ 20% inoculation

ROOM TEMP	BULK TIME
16°C / 61°F	~11 h
18°C / 64°F	~9 h
20°C / 68°F	~7.5 h
22°C / 72°F	~6.2 h
24°C / 75°F	~5 h
26°C / 79°F	~4 h
28°C / 82°F	~3.3 h
30°C / 86°F	~2.7 h

Halve inoculation → roughly double the time.

• Starter readiness NEED 4 OF 6

- ☐ At least doubled since feeding
- ☐ Domed top (not flat or sunken)
- ☐ Bubbles visible on sides
- ☐ Smells like beer + yogurt
- ☐ Stretchy, gel-like consistency
- ☐ Floats in water (optional)

• Desired Dough Temperature (DDT)

$$\text{Water} = (\text{Target} \times 4) - \text{Flour} - \text{Room} - \text{Friction}$$

Target 24–26°C ideal

Friction 2–4°C hand

Flour = room temp

Friction 5–8°C mixer

• Bake schedule (Dutch oven 250°C)

1. Preheat empty Dutch oven 60 min
2. Score, transfer, lid **on**, bake 20 min @ 250°C
3. Lid **off**, drop to 230°C, bake 22–28 min
4. Internal temp 96–99°C = done
5. Cool on rack 60 min before slicing

• Stretch & fold timing

SET	FROM BULK START	STYLE
1	0:30	Strong
2	1:00	Strong
3	1:30	Gentle
4	2:00	Gentle

Stop folding when dough is smooth, jiggly, holds shape.

• Quick troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE
Gummy crumb	Cut warm OR underbaked
Dense crumb	Underproofed bulk
Flat loaf	Overproofed bulk
No oven spring	Cold Dutch oven
Pale crust	No steam, short bake
Wall holes	Tight final shape

• Salt percentage

1.8% faster, less salt

2.0% standard

2.2% slower, keeps better